



Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Project Middleware & Fintech Integration Platform

Prepared by
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Business Requirements Document (BRD) Middleware & Fintech Integration Platform Procurement

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1. Executive Summary

Mawarid Finance intends to procure an **enterprise-grade middleware and integration platform** that acts as a secure abstraction layer (“**The Shield**”) between internal core banking systems and external fintech partners, payment infrastructures, and ecosystem participants.

This document is intentionally **outcome-focused and technology-agnostic**. It defines *what Mawarid Finance needs to achieve* rather than *how vendors must implement it*. Vendors are encouraged to propose **innovative, standards-based architectures** that meet the stated business, security, regulatory, and operational outcomes.

2. Strategic Objectives

The selected solution must enable Mawarid Finance to:

- 1. Accelerate Fintech Partnerships**
Enable rapid, repeatable onboarding of fintech partners with minimal custom development.
- 2. Protect Core Banking Systems**
Eliminate direct external access to ICBS while allowing controlled, auditable interactions.
- 3. Meet Regulatory & Cybersecurity Obligations**
Comply with CBUAE, NESAC, and UAE data protection requirements through Zero-Trust security principles.

4. **Support Islamic Finance Products**

Seamlessly integrate Shariah-compliant products including Islamic financing, Wakalah deposits, and Letters of Guarantee.

5. **Operate at Scale**

Sustain high-volume, low-latency transactions (e.g., micro-lending, BNPL) without degradation or risk to core systems.

3. Scope Definition

3.1 In Scope

The solution must support integration with:

- **Core Banking Systems**
 - ICBS (no modification permitted)
- **External Parties**
 - Fintech partners (lending, BNPL, wallets, marketplaces)
 - CBUAE payment infrastructures (phased integration)
 - Credit bureaus and government registries
- **Business Domains**
 - Retail & SME Islamic financing
 - Salary-linked lending
 - BNPL / POS financing
 - Micro-lending and wallet-based lending
 - Wakalah deposits
 - Letters of Guarantee

3.2 Explicitly Out of Scope

- Replacement or modification of **ICBS**
- Front-end customer or merchant applications
- Card management and ATM switching
- SWIFT or correspondent banking

4. Key Design Principles (Non-Prescriptive)

Vendors must design solutions that adhere to the following principles:

- **Standards-Based** – Open APIs, open security standards, no proprietary lock-in

- **Zero-Trust by Design** – Every request authenticated, authorized, and validated
 - **Configurable, Not Hard-Coded** – Business rules and limits managed via configuration
 - **Phased & Evolvable** – Supports staged migration and future expansion
 - **Operationally Transparent** – Real-time visibility, auditability, and control
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5. Functional Outcome Requirements

5.1 External Integration Management

The platform must enable Mawarid Finance to:

- Expose secure, versioned APIs to external partners
- Abstract internal system complexity from partners
- Control traffic, usage quotas, and partner entitlements
- Support synchronous APIs and file-based integrations

Constraint: Message queue technologies are explicitly excluded. All designs must rely on APIs, file transfers, database interactions, and callback/webhook mechanisms.

5.2 Security & Identity Outcomes

The solution must demonstrate how it achieves the following security outcomes:

- Isolation of external and internal traffic through network segmentation
- Enforcement of Zero-Trust Network Architecture (ZTNA)
- Secure operation across on-premise, cloud, or hybrid deployments
- Support for industry-standard authentication and federation mechanisms
- Secure lifecycle management of secrets, keys, and certificates
- Fine-grained authorization at partner, API, and data-field level

Vendors must **describe** their approach rather than assume a specific technology stack.

5.3 Data Protection & Privacy

The solution must ensure:

- Encryption of all data in transit and at rest
- Field-level data protection (masking, tokenization, or encryption)
- Enforcement of data classification and DLP policies at integration points
- Secure handling of customer consent and data sharing permissions

5.4 Orchestration & Business Flow Enablement

The platform must **allow Mawarid Finance** to:

- Orchestrate multi-step business processes across systems
- Execute parallel service calls where appropriate
- Manage retries, failures, and compensating actions
- Support both real-time and long-running processes

Vendors should explain how non-technical users can maintain and evolve these flows.

5.5 Observability & Control

The solution must provide:

- Centralized, real-time operational dashboards
- End-to-end transaction traceability
- Security event monitoring and SIEM integration
- Configurable alerts for operational and security thresholds
- Immediate ability to suspend partner access or APIs when required

5.6 Fintech Onboarding Enablement

Vendors must describe an **end-to-end fintech onboarding journey**, including:

- Partner **registration and identity verification**
 - Access approval and governance workflows
 - Sandbox and testing enablement
 - Promotion to **production and ongoing** access management
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6. Non-Functional Outcome Requirements

6.1 Availability & Resilience

The solution must support:

- High availability **with no single point** of failure
- Defined recovery objectives (RTO/RPO)
- Controlled **degradation during** backend outages

6.2 Performance & Scalability

The solution must:

- Sustain **high transaction volumes** and burst traffic
 - Scale horizontally without service disruption
 - Enforce traffic shaping and quality-of-service policies
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7. Phased Implementation Requirement

The proposed solution must explicitly support the following **phased model**:

1. **Phase 1 – Fintech Enablement**
 - Middleware live for fintech integrations
 - CBUAE payment channels remain directly connected to ICBS
2. **Phase 2 – Channel Migration**
 - Gradual routing of ICCS, DDS, FTS, NPSS through middleware
 - Minimal disruption and parallel run support
3. **Phase 3 – Platform Optimization**
 - Optimization and simplification of the integration landscape

Vendors must explain how migration risk is managed.

8. Vendor Proposal Expectations

Vendor responses must include:

1. Conceptual architecture diagrams (zones, trust boundaries, data flows)
2. Security architecture (authentication, encryption, key management)
3. Fintech onboarding workflow example
4. Phased implementation and migration plan
5. Assumptions, dependencies, and risks

Prescriptive product comparisons are discouraged in favor of **solution rationale**.

9. Evaluation Focus

Proposals will be evaluated primarily on:

- Ability to meet stated outcomes
- Security and regulatory alignment
- Flexibility and future-proofing
- Implementation credibility

- Total cost of ownership over time

10. Vendor Operating, Governance & Commercial Expectations

10.1 Operating Model & Governance

Vendors must describe the proposed operating and governance model, including:

- Clear delineation of responsibilities between Mawarid Finance business teams, IT, and the vendor
- Day-to-day operational model and change management approach
- Support structure (L1 / L2 / L3) with defined response and resolution SLAs
- Release, patching, and upgrade management approach without service disruption
- Incident management, escalation, and communication procedures

The proposed model must ensure Mawarid Finance retains operational control, visibility, and decision authority at all times.

10.2 Capability Building & Knowledge Transfer

Vendors must explain how they will:

- Enable Mawarid Finance technical and business teams to operate and evolve the platform independently
- Deliver structured knowledge transfer and comprehensive technical and operational documentation
- Provide post-go-live support and stabilization during the initial operating period

Vendors are encouraged to differentiate through their enablement approach rather than prescriptive training formats.

10.3 Compliance & Audit Readiness

Vendors must demonstrate how the proposed solution:

- Supports internal and external audit requirements
- Provides standard or configurable compliance and regulatory reporting
- Produces audit artifacts and evidence on demand
- Supports periodic security, regulatory, and compliance assessments

10.4 Data Management & Retention

Vendors must explain how the solution addresses:

- Data retention and archival policies aligned with regulatory requirements
- UAE data residency and data sovereignty obligations
- Secure data deletion, masking, or anonymization when legally required
- Historical data management for audit, investigation, and regulatory review purposes

10.5 Commercial & Licensing Transparency

Vendor proposals must clearly outline:

- Proposed licensing model (subscription, consumption-based, perpetual, or hybrid)
- Key cost components and drivers impacting Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)
- Assumptions regarding number of partners, APIs, and transaction volumes
- Cost implications of future scalability, expansion, and additional use cases

11. Submission Instructions

All proposals must be submitted in PDF format to the contact person by **January 30, 2026**

Mawarid reserves the right to shortlist and invite selected vendors for presentations and further clarification.

Interested vendors should submit:

- Company profile and relevant products /services.
- Proposed technical approach and timeline.
- Similar previous projects.
- Budget breakdown.

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